ACUTE Lab Website — Content Management Guide

// ACUTE Lab Website — Content Management Guide

This guide explains how to use the ACUTE Content Manager (CMS) to edit the lab website without touching code.

Table of Contents

Already set up? Jump straight to Quick Start.

Quick Start (Already Set Up?)

If this computer has **already** been through the one-time setup — tools installed, SSH key added, and the website cloned — you can skip the rest of Getting Started. This is the entire day-to-day workflow:

1. Open your terminal — **Git Bash** on Windows, **Terminal** on macOS.
2. Go to your website folder, pull the latest changes, and start the CMS:

```
cd <your website folder>/acute_web    # e.g. /d/work/acute_web — the folder you cloned earlier
git pull origin main                  # get colleagues' latest changes
cd cms
npm run dev                           # start the CMS
```

3. Open your browser at **http://localhost:3000** and edit content.
4. When done, **publish** from the **Deploy** page (or the orange **Build** +

Commit + **Push** button — see Section 15).

5. Back in the terminal, press **Ctrl+C** to stop the CMS.

> **Tip (Windows):** skip typing the folder path — in File Explorer, right-click inside your `acute_web` folder and choose **Git Bash Here** to open a terminal already in the right place.
>
> **First time on this computer, or unsure where your folder is?** Start with Section 1: Getting Started.

---

1. Getting Started

First-time setup on a new computer happens in **four stages**. Do Stages A–C in order; Stage D is optional. After this one-time setup you only ever repeat the Quick Start workflow.

Stage	What you do	What it's for	Required?
A — Install the tools	Install **Node.js** + **Git**	Running the CMS on your computer	▯ Required
B — Set up SSH	Add a GitHub **SSH key**	**Publishing** (pushing) your changes	▯ Required
C — Get the website	**Clone** the repo into a folder you choose	Having the website files locally to edit	▯ Required (once)
D — Ruby + Jekyll	Install **Ruby** + **Jekyll**	The optional local **Preview** only	☐ Optional

You can edit and publish the whole website with just Stages A–C. Stage D only adds the in-browser **Preview** and is covered in Section 14 — feel free to skip it for now.

Which terminal to use

Operating System	Terminal
Windows	Open **Git Bash** (installed with Git for Windows). Search for "Git Bash" in the Start menu, or right-click inside a folder and choose **Git Bash Here**.
macOS	Open **Terminal** (Applications > Utilities > Terminal)

All commands in this guide work in both Git Bash (Windows) and Terminal (macOS). **Windows users: use Git Bash, not Command Prompt (cmd).**

Stage A — Install the tools

Install both of these:

- **Node.js** (version 20 or higher) — download here — runs the CMS.
- **Git** — download here — downloads and publishes the website. On Windows, install **“Git for Windows”** with all defaults; this also gives you **Git Bash**.

Installing Node.js (Windows)

The nodejs.org download page offers several options — here is exactly what to pick:

1. Choose the big **LTS** button (not “Current”). LTS is the stable, long-term-support release. The exact version number doesn’t matter as long as it’s the current LTS — this project works on any LTS (20, 22, or newer).
2. Download the **Windows Installer (.msi)**, **64-bit** version. This is correct for virtually every Windows laptop. Only choose **ARM64** if you have an ARM-based PC (e.g. a Snapdragon device) — this is rare.
3. Run the installer and **keep all the defaults**. You do **not** need to tick the optional “Tools for Native Modules” / Chocolatey checkbox.
4. To confirm it worked, open **Git Bash** and run `node -v` — you should see a version number.

> **You do not need Docker.** The CMS is a plain Node.js app — just install Node.js and run `npm install`. Docker would add a large download and extra complexity for no benefit here.

Stage B — Set up an SSH key

You need a GitHub SSH key to **publish** your changes. This is a one-time setup per computer. Follow **Section 2: Setting Up SSH for GitHub** now, then come back here for Stage C.

Stage C — Get the website (clone)

Step 1 — Choose where to store the website

The website folder can live **anywhere you like** — it does **not** have to be in Documents. Another drive (e.g. `D:`) or an external disk is fine. Just pick a spot you’ll remember, and ideally:

- **avoid** folders synced by OneDrive / Dropbox / iCloud (syncing can corrupt the project files), and
- **avoid spaces** in the folder path where possible.

Step 2 — Open a terminal *inside* that folder

The clone command downloads into wherever your terminal currently is, so get your terminal into your chosen folder first. The easiest ways avoid typing any path by hand:

Windows — “Git Bash Here” (recommended):

1. In File Explorer, open (or create) the folder where you want the website to live.
2. Right-click an empty area inside it → on Windows 11 click **Show more options** first → choose **Git Bash Here**.
3. A terminal opens already located in that folder. Done — go to Step 3.

Windows — copy the path instead:

1. In File Explorer, click once in the **address bar** at the top; it turns into text like `D:\work`. Copy it (**Ctrl**+**C**).
2. In Git Bash, type `cd` (with a trailing space), then paste (**Shift**+**Insert**, or right-click → Paste).
3. Git Bash expects forward slashes and a lowercase drive letter, so convert `D:\work` → `/d/work`, and press Enter. Example: `cd /d/work`

macOS:

- Type `cd` (with a trailing space) in Terminal, then **drag the folder from Finder onto the Terminal window** — the full path is inserted automatically. Press Enter.
- Or right-click the folder in Finder, hold **⌥ Option**, choose **Copy "…" as Pathname**, then paste after `cd`.

Step 3 — Clone the website

With your terminal now inside your chosen folder, download the website:

```
git clone git@github.com:Acute-hi-is/Acute-hi-is.github.io.git acute_web
```

This creates a new **`acute_web`** folder inside your chosen location, containing the whole website.

> **Write down your path.** From now on the website lives at *your folder* + `/acute_web`, and you'll go there every time you work. Example: Windows `D:\work` → in Git Bash that's **`/d/work/acute_web`**.

Step 4 — Install the CMS (one time)

```
cd acute_web/cms
npm install
```

This downloads everything the CMS needs. It only has to be done once (and again after any CMS update).

Starting the CMS (every time)

```
cd <your website folder>/acute_web    # e.g. /d/work/acute_web  (or use "Git Bash Here")
git pull origin main                  # get colleagues' latest changes
cd cms
npm run dev                           # start the CMS
```

Open your browser and go to **http://localhost:3000**.

Stopping the CMS

Press **Ctrl**+**C** in the terminal.

---

2. Setting Up SSH for GitHub

To publish changes from the CMS, your computer needs an SSH key linked to your GitHub account. You only need to do this **once per computer**.

If you can already push to GitHub (test with `ssh -T git@github.com`), skip this section.

Step 1: Open your terminal

- **Windows:** Open **Git Bash** (search for it in the Start menu)
- **macOS:** Open **Terminal** (Applications > Utilities > Terminal)

Step 2: Check if you already have an SSH key

Type:

```bash
ls ~/.ssh/id_ed25519.pub
```

- If you see a file path, **you already have a key** — skip to Step 4
- If you see "No such file or directory", continue to Step 3

Step 3: Generate a new SSH key

Type (replace with your email):

```bash
ssh-keygen -t ed25519 -C "your-name@hi.is"
```

You will be asked three questions. **Press Enter for all three** to accept the defaults:

```
Enter file in which to save the key
(/c/Users/YourName/.ssh/id_ed25519): [press Enter]
Enter passphrase (empty for no passphrase): [press Enter]
Enter same passphrase again: [press Enter]
```

You should see output like:

```
Your identification has been saved in
/c/Users/YourName/.ssh/id_ed25519
Your public key has been saved in
/c/Users/YourName/.ssh/id_ed25519.pub
```

Step 4: Copy your public key

Type:

```bash
cat ~/.ssh/id_ed25519.pub
```

This prints a long line starting with `ssh-ed25519 AAAA...` and ending with your email.

Select the entire line and copy it: - **Windows (Git Bash):** select with mouse, right-click > Copy (or Ctrl+Insert) - **macOS:** select with mouse, Cmd+C

Step 5: Add the key to GitHub

1. Open your browser and go to: **https://github.com/settings/keys**
    - If you're not logged in, log in first
2. Click the green **New SSH key** button
3. Fill in:
    - **Title**: a name for this computer (e.g. "Lab laptop" or "Office PC")
    - **Key type**: keep as "Authentication Key"
    - **Key**: paste the key you copied in Step 4

4. Click **Add SSH key**
5. GitHub may ask you to confirm your password

Step 6: Test the connection

Back in your terminal, type:

```
ssh -T git@github.com
```

If this is your first time connecting, you'll see:

```
The authenticity of host 'github.com' can't be established.
Are you sure you want to continue connecting (yes/no)?
```

Type **yes** and press Enter.

You should then see:

```
Hi YourUsername! You've successfully authenticated, but GitHub does
not provide shell access.
```

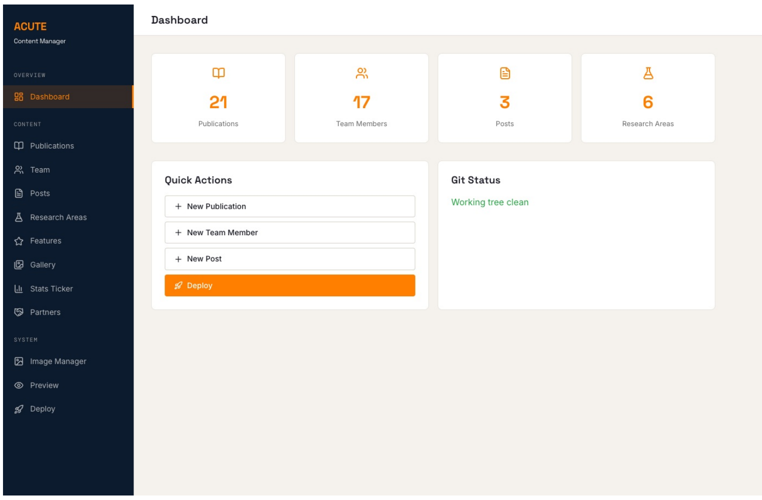
If you see this message, **you're done**. You can now push changes from the CMS.

If it doesn't work, see Section 16: Troubleshooting.

---

3. The Dashboard

When you open the CMS, you land on the **Dashboard**.



Dashboard

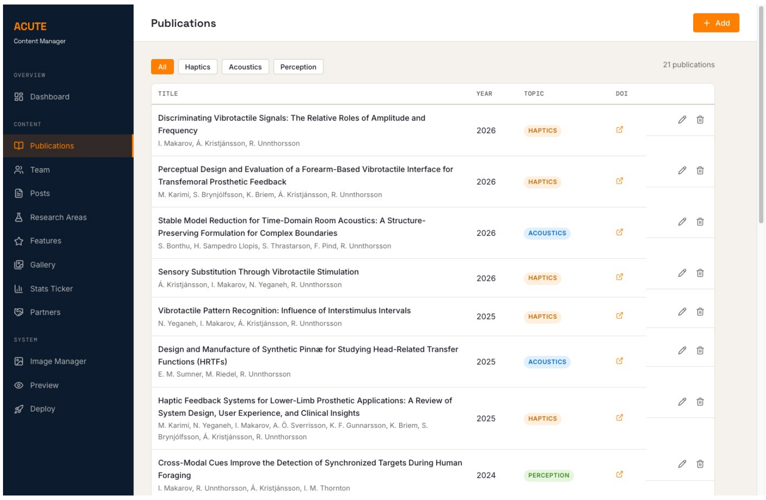
The dashboard shows:

- **Content counts** — how many publications, team members, posts, and research areas exist
- **Quick Actions** — shortcuts to create new content or deploy changes
- **Git Status** — whether you have unsaved (uncommitted) changes

---

4. Managing Publications

Click **Publications** in the sidebar.



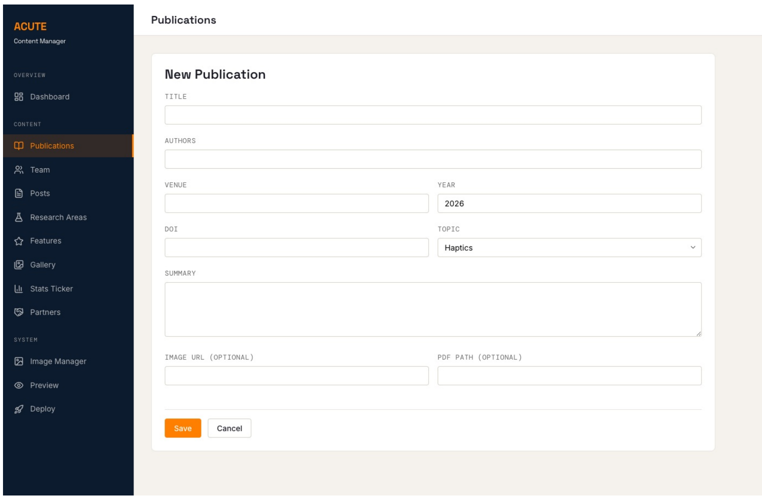
Publications list

What you see

- A list of all publications sorted by year (newest first)
- **Filter buttons** at the top: All, Haptics, Acoustics, Perception
- Each row shows the title, authors, year, topic badge, and a DOI link

Adding a new publication

1. Click the orange + **Add** button (top right)
2. Fill in the form:



Publication form

Field	What to enter
Title	Full paper title
Authors	Author names, comma-separated (e.g. "I. Makarov, R. Unnthorsson")
Venue	Journal or conference name
Year	Publication year
DOI	The DOI identifier (e.g. "10.3390/s25010001")
Topic	Select: Haptics, Acoustics, or Perception
Summary	A 1-2 sentence description of the paper
Image URL	Optional — path to a thumbnail image

PDF Path	Optional — path to a locally hosted PDF

3. Click **Save**

Editing a publication

Click the pencil icon on any row. The form opens with the current values. Make your changes and click **Save**.

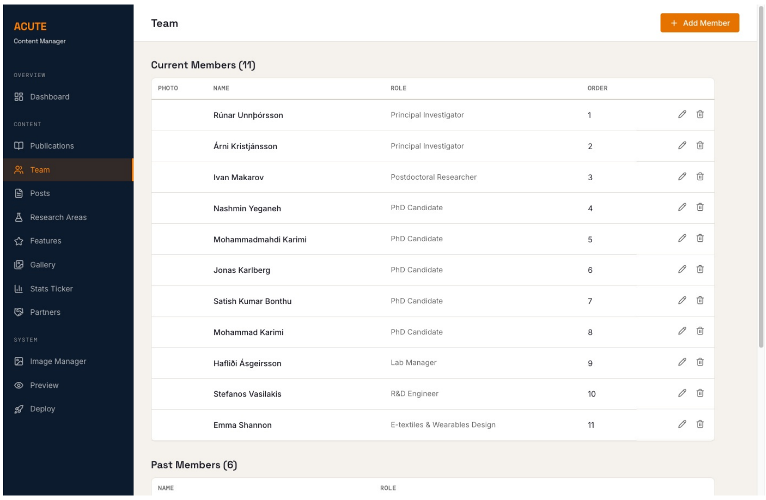
Deleting a publication

Click the trash icon on any row. A confirmation dialog appears — click **Delete** to confirm.

---

5. Managing Team Members

Click **Team** in the sidebar.



Team page

Members are grouped into **Current Members** and **Past Members**.

Adding a new team member

1. Click + **Add Member** (top right)
2. Fill in:
   - **Name** — full name
   - **Role** — e.g. “PhD Candidate”, “Postdoctoral Researcher”
   - **Photo** — click Upload to add a photo (auto-compressed to 400x400)
   - **Email** — optional
   - **Profile URL** — optional link to university page
   - **Status** — “current” or “past”
   - **Order** — display order (lower numbers appear first)
   - **Research Project** — optional; pick the member’s main project from the dropdown (choose “— None —” to leave it unset)
   - **Bio** — write in the text area. This supports Markdown formatting
3. Click **Save**

Linking a member to their research project

The **Research Project** dropdown ties a member to one of the projects on the Projects page. When set, a link to that project appears:

- on the **homepage**, in the pop-up bio panel that opens when you click a team member (next to "Read more"), and
- on the member's own **profile page**, below their bio.

The dropdown lists every project you've created. Leave it on **"— None —"** for people without a single main project (e.g. principal investigators or external collaborators). To change or remove the link later, edit the member, pick a different project (or "— None —"), and save.

Moving a member to "Past"

Edit the member, change **Status** from "current" to "past", and save.

Editing a bio

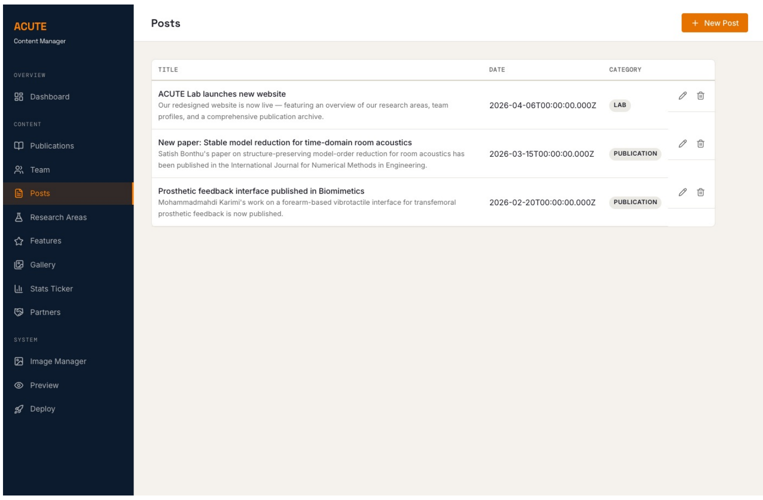
Click the pencil icon on any member. The bio field supports Markdown:

- `**bold text**` for bold
- `*italic text*` for italic
- `[link text](url)` for links
- Blank lines for new paragraphs

---

6. Managing Blog Posts

Click **Posts** in the sidebar.



Posts page

Adding a new post

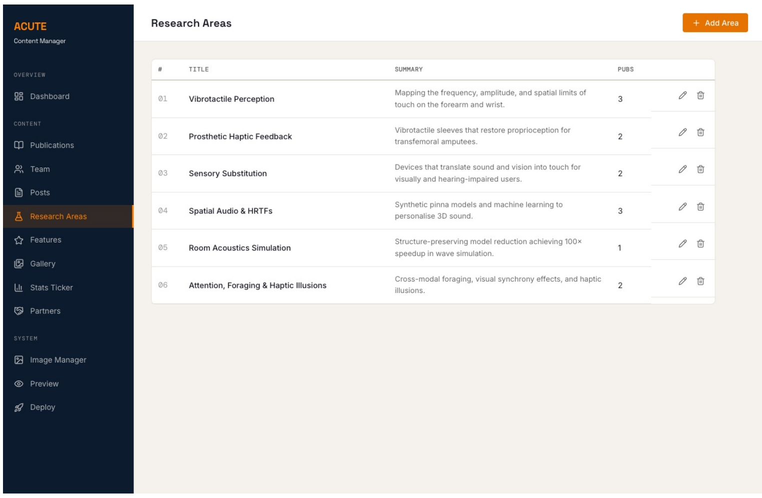
1. Click + **New Post** (top right)
2. Fill in:
   - **Title** — the post headline
   - **Date** — publication date
   - **Category** — e.g. "publication", "lab", "event"
   - **Excerpt** — a short summary (shown on the homepage)
   - **Content** — the full post body (Markdown supported)
3. Click **Save**

The post filename is auto-generated from the date and title.

---

7. Managing Research Areas

Click **Research Areas** in the sidebar.



Research Areas page

Each research area has a title, summary, description paragraphs, and linked publications.

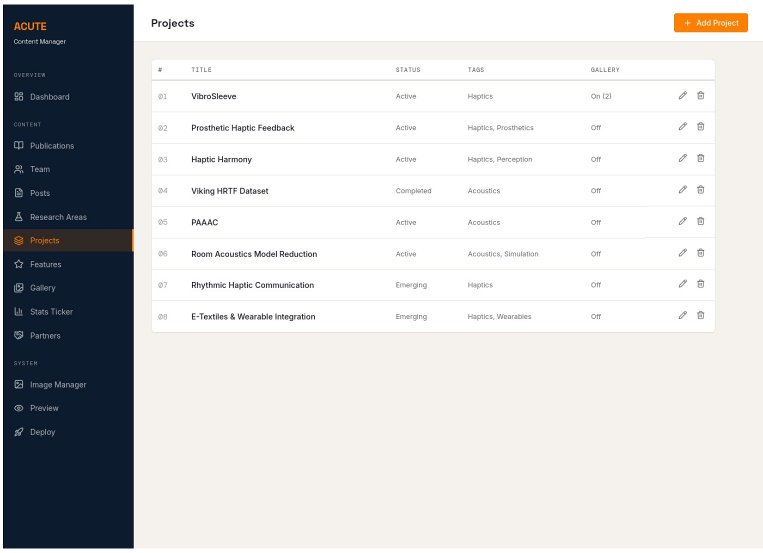
Editing a research area

1. Click the pencil icon on any row
2. The form includes:
   - **Title** and **Summary**
   - **Description** — multiple paragraphs (use Add/Remove buttons to manage)
   - **Publications** — linked papers with text and DOI (use Add/Remove buttons)
   - **Images** — main image and highlight image
3. Click **Save**

---

8. Managing Projects

Click **Projects** in the sidebar.



Projects page

Each project gets its own page at `acute.hi.is/projects/<slug>/`. Projects are sorted by **Display Order** (lower numbers first) on the projects index page, and each can optionally show a **photo & video gallery** at the bottom of its detail page.

> **Don't confuse this with the homepage Gallery** (Section 10). That one drives the carousel of lab photos on the homepage. *This* gallery lives inside an individual project's page and is opt-in per project.

Adding a new project

1. Click the orange + **Add Project** button (top right)
2. Fill in:

Field	What to enter
Title	Project title
Status	"Active", "Completed", or "Emerging". Drives the badge colour on the projects index.
Tags	Comma-separated keywords (e.g. "Haptics, Wearables"). Shown as chips on the index card.
Display Order	Lower numbers appear first on the projects index.
Team	People involved (free text — e.g. "Stefanos V., Runar U.")
Partners	Collaborating institutions or companies
Funding	Grant / funder names
Description	Body content in **Markdown**. Appears as the main column of the project page.
Key Publications	Optional. Add citation text, venue, and DOI for each — they render as a list in the project sidebar.

3. Click **Save**

Adding a photo & video gallery

Each project page can show an optional gallery at the bottom.

1. Edit the project
2. Tick **“Show photo & video gallery on this project page”**
3. The **Gallery Items** editor appears. Click + **Add Photo** or + **Add Video** to add an item
4. Reorder items with the ▲▼ arrows on each row; delete with the ×

For photo items:

- Click **Upload** to add an image. Uploaded photos are auto-compressed to max 1400 px wide, JPEG.
- A **“Apply ACUTE watermark to next upload”** checkbox appears above the upload button — leave it checked (the default) to stamp the ACUTE long logo discreetly in the bottom-right corner of the image. Uncheck only if you don’t want a watermark on that specific upload (e.g. partner-supplied images that already carry their own branding).
- Fill in **Alt text** (for accessibility) and an optional **Caption** (shown beneath the photo on the live page).

For video items:

- Paste an **embed URL** — not the watch URL. YouTube and Vimeo both expose this:
  - YouTube: from `https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ABC123` → use `https://www.youtube.com/embed/ABC123`
  - Vimeo: from `https://vimeo.com/123456` → use `https://player.vimeo.com/video/123456`
- Add an optional **Caption**.
- Videos render as a responsive 16:9 embed in the gallery grid.

5. Click **Save**

> **Where the gallery appears:** the full gallery (photos and videos) shows at the bottom of the project’s own page. In addition, the gallery **photos** now appear as a thumbnail strip on the project’s card on the main Projects page, so visitors get a preview without opening the project. Videos are shown on the project page only.

Disabling the gallery

Untick **“Show photo & video gallery on this project page”** and save. The gallery items are preserved (in case you want to re-enable later) — they just won’t render on the live page.

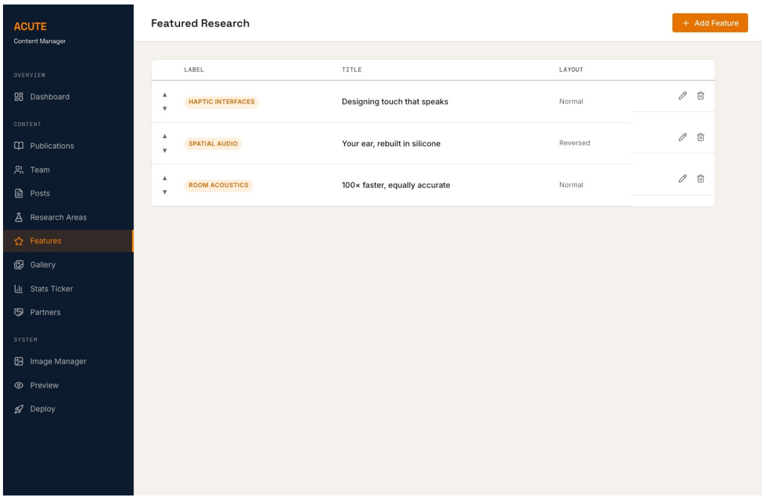
Editing or deleting a project

Click the pencil icon on any row to edit, or the trash icon (with confirmation) to delete. Deleting a project removes its source file; uploaded gallery images stay in the repo and can be cleaned up via the Image Manager.

---

9. Managing Featured Research

Click **Features** in the sidebar.



Features page

These are the highlighted research sections on the homepage.

Reordering

Use the up/down arrows on the left of each row to change the display order.

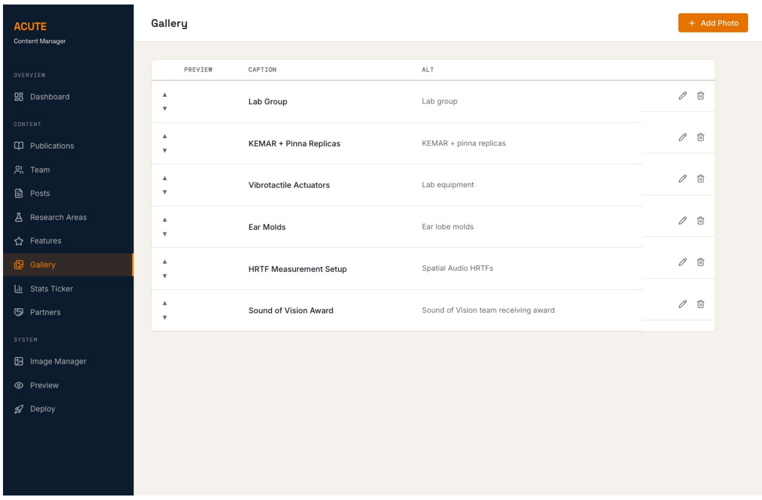
Editing a feature

Click the pencil icon. You can change the label, title, description text, DOI link, image, and layout direction (Normal or Reversed).

---

10. Managing the Homepage Gallery

Click **Gallery** in the sidebar.



Gallery page

The gallery controls the **photo carousel on the homepage**. (For galleries that live inside an individual project page, see Section 8: Managing Projects instead.)

Adding a photo

1. Click + **Add Photo** (top right)

2. Set the **image path** (type it or use Upload)
3. Add a **caption** and **alt text** (for accessibility)
4. Click **Save**

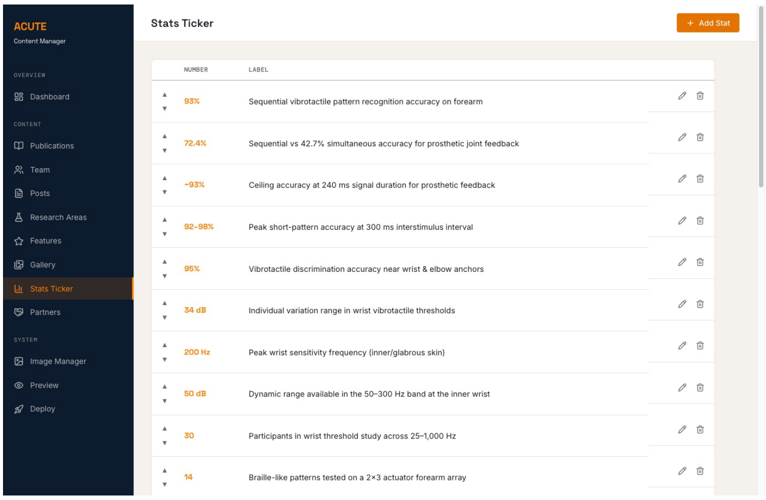
Reordering photos

Use the up/down arrows to change the carousel order.

---

11. Managing the Stats Ticker

Click **Stats Ticker** in the sidebar.



Stats Ticker page

The stats ticker is the scrolling numbers bar on the homepage.

Adding a stat

1. Click + **Add Stat** (top right)
2. Enter the **Number** (e.g. “93%”, “200 Hz”, “34 dB”)
3. Enter the **Label** (description of what the number means)
4. Click **Save**

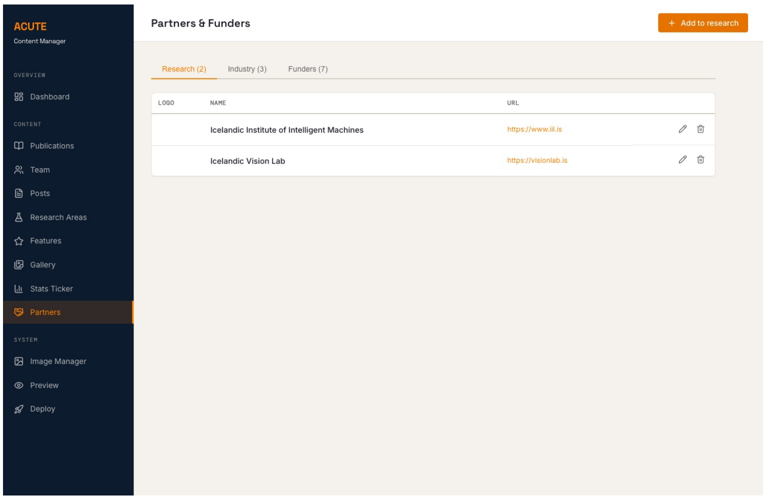
Reordering

Use the up/down arrows to change the scroll order.

---

12. Managing Partners & Funders

Click **Partners** in the sidebar.



Partners page

Partners are organized in three tabs:

- **Research** — academic research partners
- **Industry** — industry collaborators
- **Funders** — funding organizations

Adding a partner

1. Select the correct tab
2. Click the orange + **Add to [group]** button
3. Fill in the name, website URL, logo (use Upload), and alt text
4. Click **Save**

Logos are auto-compressed to 300x150 pixels.

---

13. Image Manager

Click **Image Manager** in the sidebar.

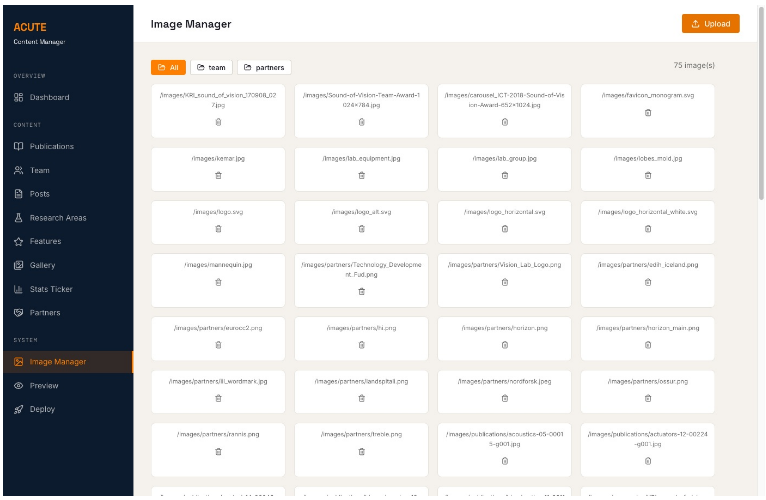


Image Manager page

Browsing images

Use the filter tabs at the top: - **All** — every image on the site - **team** — team member photos - **partners** — partner and funder logos - **projects** — project gallery photos (one subfolder per project, e.g. `projects/vibrosleeve/…`)

Uploading images

1. Click the orange **Upload** button (top right)
2. Select one or more files
3. Images are automatically compressed depending on where they're uploaded:
    - **Team** photos: max 400×400, JPEG
    - **Partner** logos: max 300×150, PNG
    - **Project gallery** photos: max 1400 px wide, JPEG, with the **ACUTE watermark** stamped in the bottom-right (toggleable per-upload — see Section 8)
    - **Other** images: max 1200 px wide, JPEG

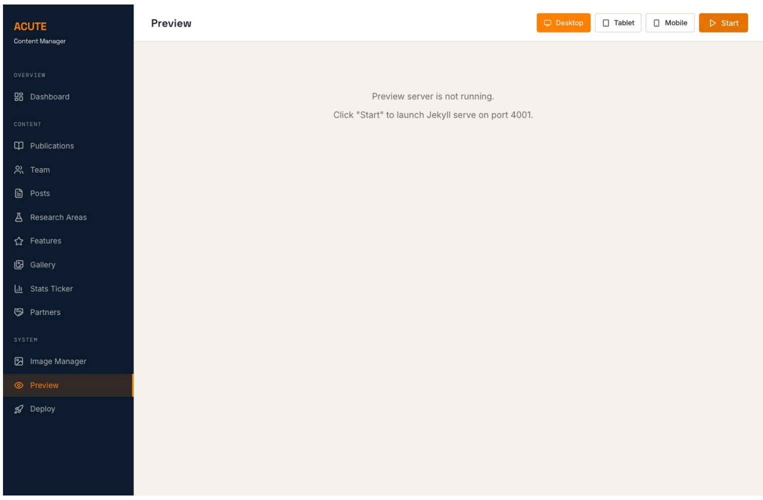
Deleting images

Click the trash icon below any image and confirm.

---

14. Previewing the Website

Click **Preview** in the sidebar.



Preview page

Note: This feature requires Ruby and Jekyll installed on your computer — this is the optional **Stage D** from Getting Started. You can skip it entirely and your changes will still work after publishing.

Installing Ruby + Jekyll (if you want Preview):

In the commands below, replace `<your website folder>/acute_web` with the actual path to your cloned website (e.g. `/d/work/acute_web`).

OS	How to install
Windows	Download RubyInstaller (Ruby+Devkit version). After install, open a new Git Bash and run: `gem install jekyll bundler` then `cd <your website folder>/acute_web &&`

	`bundle install`
macOS	Ruby is pre-installed. Run: `gem install jekyll bundler` then `cd <your website folder>/acute_web && bundle install`

Using Preview:

1. Click the orange **Start** button
2. Wait for Jekyll to build the site (may take 10-20 seconds the first time)
3. The website appears in the preview area
4. Use the **Desktop** / **Tablet** / **Mobile** buttons to test different screen sizes
5. Click **Stop** when done

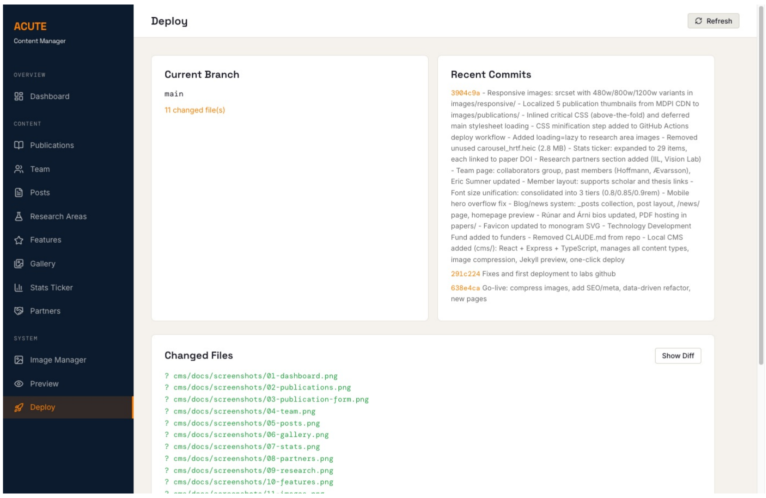
Every time you save content in the CMS, the preview updates automatically.

If you don't have Ruby installed, skip this step — just publish your changes and check the live website instead.

---

15. Publishing Your Changes

When you're happy with your edits, click **Deploy** in the sidebar.

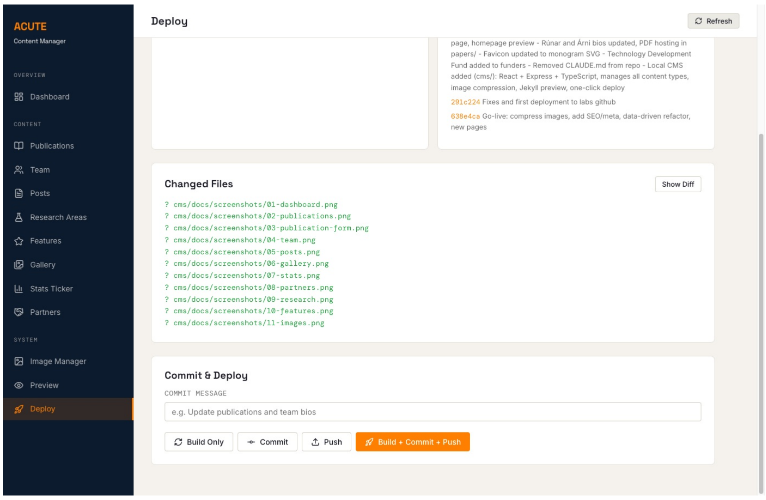


Deploy page — top

Step 1: Review your changes

- **Changed Files** shows everything you've modified
- Click **Show Diff** to see exactly what changed

Step 2: Commit and push



Deploy page — bottom

1. Type a short **commit message** describing your changes (e.g. “Add new publication by Karimi et al.”)
2. Click **Commit** to save your changes locally
3. Click **Push** to publish to GitHub

Or use the orange **Build** + **Commit** + **Push** button to do everything in one click.

After pushing, the website updates automatically.

Important

- Always **pull the latest changes** before starting work (`git pull origin main` in terminal)
- Write clear commit messages so others know what changed
- Only one person should edit at a time to avoid conflicts

---

16. Troubleshooting

The CMS won’t start

- Make sure you’re in the `cms/` directory
- Run `npm install` again to ensure dependencies are up to date
- Check that Node.js 20+ is installed: `node --version`
- **Windows:** Make sure you’re using **Git Bash**, not Command Prompt (cmd). The CMS may not work correctly in cmd.

Changes don’t appear on the live site

- Make sure you committed AND pushed (check the Deploy page)
- Wait a minute — the site may take a moment to update after pushing

Preview doesn’t work

- Preview requires Ruby and Jekyll installed locally
- If you don’t have them, skip preview — your changes will still work after pushing

“Merge conflict” error when pushing

- This means someone else edited the same file at the same time
- Ask a team member with git experience to help resolve it
- To avoid this: always `git pull` before starting, and coordinate with colleagues

“Permission denied (publickey)” when pushing

- Your SSH key is not set up for GitHub
- Follow Section 2: Setting Up SSH for GitHub to create and add your key
- If you’ve already set up a key, try running `ssh-add ~/.ssh/id_ed25519` in your terminal, then try again
- If the issue persists, ask Stefanos for help

“Access denied” / “you don’t have access” when pushing (but your key works)

This is **different** from the “publickey” error above. Here GitHub *recognises* you — your key is fine — but says you’re not allowed to push. The error looks like:

```
ERROR: Permission to Acute-hi-is/Acute-hi-is.github.io.git denied to
SOMEUSERNAME.
```

The **username** in that message is the key to diagnosing it. First, find out which GitHub account your computer is actually using — in your terminal run:

```
ssh -T git@github.com
```

It replies `Hi USERNAME! You've successfully authenticated…`. Compare that `USERNAME` with the account you expect. There are two common causes:

Cause 1 — You only have read access (most common). The username is *correct* (it’s your account), but you were added to the organisation without write permission on this repository. Being an organisation member gives **read** access to repos by default — it does **not** automatically grant **write** (push) access. Ask Stefanos to grant you **Write** access on the website repo specifically:

> Repo → **Settings → Collaborators and teams** → **Add people** → your username → role **Write**.

Once that’s done, pushing works — no changes needed on your computer.

Cause 2 — Your SSH key is on the wrong GitHub account. The username is **not** the account you expected (e.g. you have two GitHub accounts and set the key up on the other one). A single SSH key can belong to only one account, and GitHub decides who you are from the key — so pushes go out as the wrong account, which has no access. To fix:

1. Log into GitHub as the **wrong** account → **Settings → SSH and GPG keys** → delete the key that matches your computer.
2. Log into GitHub as the **correct** account (the one with repo access) → **Settings → SSH and GPG keys → New SSH key** → paste the output of `cat ~/.ssh/id_ed25519.pub`.
3. Run `ssh -T git@github.com` again — it should now greet you as the

correct account. Then retry the push.

If both could apply (wrong account *and* read-only), fix the account first, then make sure that account has **Write** access (Cause 1).

I accidentally created a duplicate team member (or project)

If you see **two entries with the same name**, one was probably created with + **Add Member** when you meant to **edit** the existing one. To fix:

- Delete the **duplicate** you just created (trash icon on the Team page), and instead click the **pencil** icon on the original entry to make your changes.
- Keep the **original** entry where possible — deleting and re-adding changes the member's page address (`/team/<name>/`) and drops links such as their research project.
- If the duplicate was never pushed, you can also just discard your local changes and start again from the original.

Images look wrong or don't upload

- Supported formats: JPEG, PNG, SVG, WebP
- Images are auto-compressed on upload — the original is not kept
- Maximum recommended size before upload: 10 MB

Quick Reference

Task	Where	Button
Add a publication	Publications page	+ Add
Add a team member	Team page	+ Add Member
Add a project	Projects page	+ Add Project
Add a project gallery item	Projects → edit a project → tick "Show photo & video gallery"	+ Add Photo / + Add Video
Write a blog post	Posts page	+ New Post
Upload an image	Image Manager	Upload
Reorder items	Gallery / Stats / Features / Project gallery	Up/Down arrows
Preview the site	Preview page	Start
Publish changes	Deploy page	Build + Commit + Push

Website: https://acute.hi.is

Start the CMS: `cd cms && npm run dev` then open http://localhost:3000